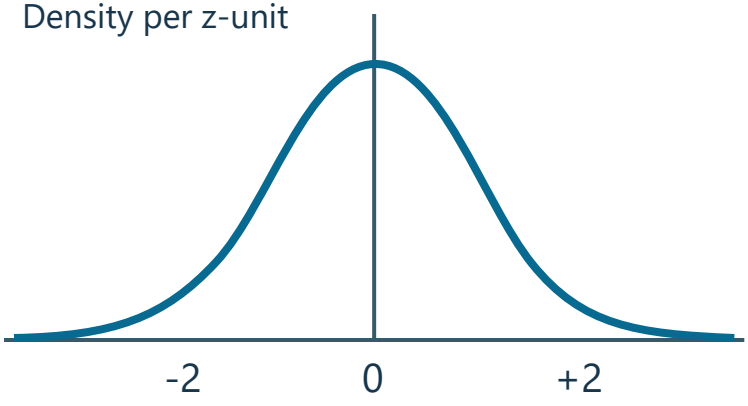
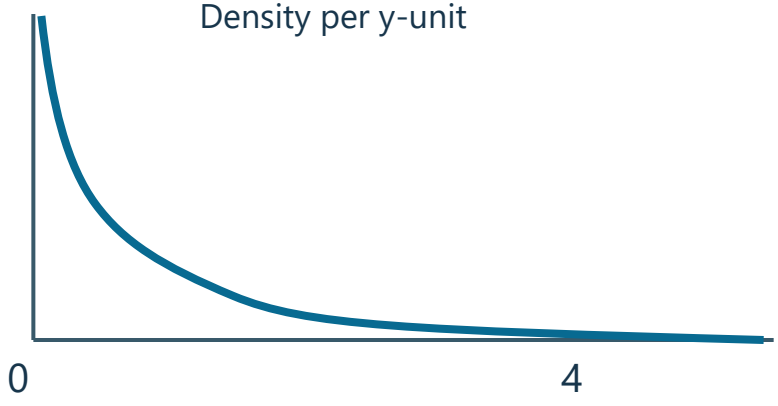
Before: signed normal distance



-2 and +2 both become 4

After: squared distance



-0.5 and +0.5 both become 0.25

Schematic shapes. Squaring changes the law; it does not merely relabel a linear axis.